



Announcement Builder

Turn plain text into polished, school-branded communications in minutes — no design software, no formatting guesswork.

■ LIVE PREVIEW

Watch the finished layout build itself as you type.

■ QR CODES

Connect a printed page to any online form or webpage.

■ PRINT READY

Save or print on standard 8.5 × 11-inch letter paper.

INSIDE THIS GUIDE

1 Getting Started

2 Entering Document Details

3 Formatting Content

4 Tables & Combined Formatting

5 QR Codes, Printing & Export

6 Troubleshooting & Best Practices

SECTION ONE

1 Getting Started

The Announcement Builder converts plain text into a consistently branded Moore Elementary communication: enter your information in the left panel, review the finished layout in the live preview on the right.

Before you begin

Draft or copy any long announcement text elsewhere first. The builder does not automatically save drafts, and **Clear** and **Start Over** removes all entered content.

THE FIVE-STEP WORKFLOW

- 1 **Enter the announcement title**
Use a clear, specific title such as “Moore Miles Volunteer Information” or “Field Day Schedule.”
- 2 **Choose a document type**
Select the category that best describes the communication. It appears in the school header and gold label bar.
- 3 **Paste and format the content**
Use the simple formatting symbols shown in sections 3 and 4. The preview updates automatically as you type.
- 4 **Add optional finishing elements**
Add a signature, switch on low-ink mode, or create a QR code that points to a public webpage or online form.
- 5 **Review and save**
Select **Download PDF**, inspect the browser print preview, then choose Save as PDF or send it to a printer.

AVAILABLE DOCUMENT TYPES

■ School Announcement

■ Parent Newsletter

■ Event Notice

■ Important Update

■ Classroom News

■ PTO Communication

■ PTO Announcement

HOW THE SCREEN IS LAID OUT**1 LEFT PANEL — WHAT YOU FILL IN**

Announcement Title	required
Document Type	dropdown
Main Content	plain text
Signature	optional
Low-ink Header & QR Code	optional

2 RIGHT PANEL — THE LIVE PREVIEW

MOORE ELEMENTARY

ANNOUNCEMENT

SCHOOL ANNOUNCEMENT

Moore Miles Volunteer Information

- Formatted exactly as it will print
- Updates with every keystroke

SECTION TWO

2 Entering Document Details

ANNOUNCEMENT TITLE

The title appears at the top of the announcement and in the running header when a printed document extends to additional pages. If the field is left blank, the preview displays *Your Announcement Title*.

MAIN CONTENT

Paste plain text into the content box. Each nonempty line becomes a paragraph unless it begins with a recognized formatting symbol. Blank lines end lists and tables but do not create large empty spaces.

Use plain text only

Do not paste HTML tags to control the design. Use the builder's supported formatting symbols instead — they are listed in section 3 and on the Quick Reference card.

SIGNATURE

Enter a **Signature Name** to add a closing block. The builder automatically adds "Sincerely," above the name. The optional **Signature Title** appears below the name in uppercase. A title will not display unless a signature name is also entered.

WHAT YOU ENTER		WHAT PRINTS
SIGNATURE NAME Moore Elementary PTO	→	<i>Sincerely,</i> Moore Elementary PTO
SIGNATURE TITLE Fundraising Committee		FUNDRAISING COMMITTEE

LOW-INK MODE

Enable **Low-ink header for printing** to reduce large areas of dark color. The navy header becomes white, header text changes to navy, and the footer becomes light gray. Gold accents remain visible so the page still reads as a Moore Elementary document.

Choose low-ink mode for high-volume printing or for pages that will be photocopied. Keep the standard header for anything families will receive as a single, full-color handout.

STANDARD HEADER

MOORE ELEMENTARY	ANNOUNCEMENT
EVENT NOTICE	
Field Day Schedule	
- Full navy header block - Best for single-copy handouts	

LOW-INK HEADER

MOORE ELEMENTARY	ANNOUNCEMENT
EVENT NOTICE	
Field Day Schedule	
- White header, navy text - Gold accents still print	

SECTION THREE

3 Formatting Content

Formatting is controlled by characters typed directly into the content box. Symbols must be entered exactly as shown below.

FORMAT	ENTER THIS	RESULT
Bold	<code>**Important date**</code>	Makes the enclosed text bold and navy.
Italic	<code>*Please note*</code>	Makes the enclosed text italic.
Section heading	<code>Important Dates:</code>	A line ending in a colon becomes a large navy heading. The colon is removed.
Subheading	<code>## Arrival Instructions</code>	Two number signs plus a space create a smaller orange heading.
Bullet	<code>- Reusable water bottle</code>	A hyphen plus a space starts a bulleted list.
Alternate bullet	<code>* Comfortable shoes</code>	An asterisk plus a space also starts a bullet.
Numbered item	<code>1. Complete the form</code>	A number plus a period or closing parenthesis creates a numbered step.
Callout	<code>! Forms are due Friday.</code>	An exclamation point at the beginning creates a highlighted callout box.
Code-style text	<code>`MOORE2026`</code>	Backticks create a compact gray code-style label.

Spacing matters

Always type a space after `##`, `-`, `*`, or a numbered-list marker. On a section-heading line, the colon must be the final character.

WHAT THE BUILDER CANNOT DO

- Nested lists are not supported.
- Custom fonts, colors, alignment, and font sizes cannot be entered in the content box.
- Images cannot be inserted into the announcement body.
- Numbered lists display the exact numbers entered and are not automatically corrected.

SECTION FOUR

4 Tables & Combined Formatting

CREATING A TABLE

Each table row must begin and end with a vertical bar, with additional vertical bars separating the columns. The first row becomes the navy table header. A row made of dashes is treated as a divider and is not displayed.

ENTER THIS

| Date | Activity | Time |

| --- | --- | --- |

| Monday | Spirit Day | All Day |

| Tuesday | Fun Run | 9:00 AM |

→

THIS PRINTS

DATE	ACTIVITY	TIME
Monday	Spirit Day	All Day
Tuesday	Fun Run	9:00 AM

Keep the same number of columns in every row. A blank line — or any line that does not begin and end with a vertical bar — ends the table.

COMBINING FORMATS: A COMPLETE EXAMPLE

ENTER THIS IN THE CONTENT BOX	THIS PRINTS						
Moore Miles begins next week. Important Dates: - Registration opens **August 20** - Forms are due **September 5** - The event begins at *8:30 AM* ## What Families Need to Do 1. Complete the permission form 2. Return it to the classroom teacher 3. Review the event schedule ! Late registrations may not receive a T-shirt.	<table> <tr> <th>MOORE ELEMENTARY</th><th>ANNOUNCEMENT</th></tr> <tr> <th colspan="2">SCHOOL ANNOUNCEMENT</th></tr> <tr> <td colspan="2"> Moore Miles Moore Miles begins next week. Important Dates ■ Registration opens August 20 ■ Forms are due September 5 ■ The event begins at <i>8:30 AM</i> WHAT FAMILIES NEED TO DO 1. Complete the permission form 2. Return it to the classroom teacher 3. Review the event schedule Late registrations may not receive a T-shirt. </td></tr> </table>	MOORE ELEMENTARY	ANNOUNCEMENT	SCHOOL ANNOUNCEMENT		Moore Miles Moore Miles begins next week. Important Dates ■ Registration opens August 20 ■ Forms are due September 5 ■ The event begins at <i>8:30 AM</i> WHAT FAMILIES NEED TO DO 1. Complete the permission form 2. Return it to the classroom teacher 3. Review the event schedule Late registrations may not receive a T-shirt.	
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SECTION FIVE

5 QR Codes, Printing & PDF Export

ADD A QR CODE

1 Enter the destination

Paste the full public URL for the webpage or form. If the address does not begin with `http://` or `https://`, the builder adds `https://` automatically.

2 Choose a position

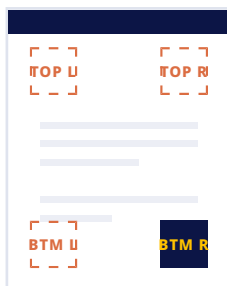
Select Bottom Right, Bottom Left, Top Right, or Top Left.

3 Choose a size

Select Small, Medium, or Large. Medium is the default.

4 Add and test

Select **Add QR Code**, then scan it with a phone before distributing the announcement. Select **Remove QR Code** to take it off.



CHOOSING A POSITION

Four placements are available. **Bottom Right** is the safest default — it stays clear of the header, the title, and most body copy, and it sits where a reader's hand naturally holds the page.

Move the code to a top corner only when the lower half of the page is full, and always confirm in the print preview that the code is not overlapping text.

Internet connection required

The QR image is generated through an external online service. The code cannot be created without an internet connection, and the destination must be accessible to the intended audience.

SAVE OR PRINT THE DOCUMENT

Download PDF opens the print dialog

It does not immediately download a file — the browser's print window handles saving.

- Select **Download PDF**.
- Choose **Save as PDF**, or select a printer.
- Use portrait orientation and standard letter-size paper.
- Enable **background graphics** where available to preserve the branded header and accent colors.
- Review every page in print preview before saving or printing.
- Longer announcements carry a running title and footer onto additional pages.

6 SECTION SIX Troubleshooting & Best Practices

IF THIS HAPPENS	WHAT TO CHECK
Formatting symbols are showing	Confirm the symbols match the guide exactly and that the required spaces are present.
A heading did not format	For a section heading, the colon must be the final character. For a subheading, enter two number signs followed by one space.
A list ended unexpectedly	Blank lines and other content types end a list. Keep consecutive list items together.
The table looks uneven	Make sure every row begins and ends with a vertical bar and contains the same number of columns.
The QR code will not appear	Enter a destination first, confirm internet access, then select Add QR Code.
Colors are missing in the PDF	Enable background graphics in the browser print settings.
Content was cleared	The builder does not save drafts or offer an undo after Clear and Start Over. Restore the text from the original source.

BEST PRACTICES

- Keep a copy of the original announcement text outside the builder.
- Use bold sparingly — reserve it for dates, deadlines, and required actions.
- Limit callout boxes to the single most important reminder on the page.
- Test every QR code and review the entire print preview before publishing.
- Use low-ink mode for high-volume printing or photocopying.
- Never enter confidential student, medical, financial, or other protected information.

Ready to publish

Once the content, QR code, signature, and print preview have all been checked, save the final PDF using a clear file name that includes the announcement topic and the date.

Quick Reference

KEEP THIS PAGE NEARBY

TYPE THIS	TO CREATE
text	Bold
<i>*text*</i>	Italic
Heading:	Major section heading
## Heading	Smaller subheading
- item	Bullet
* item	Alternate bullet
1. item	Numbered item
1) item	Alternate numbered item
! message	Callout box
`code`	Code-style text
cell cell	Table row

REMEMBER

- A space is required after ##, -, *, and numbered markers.
- A colon must end a section-heading line.
- Blank lines close lists and tables.
- Every table row starts and ends with a vertical bar.
- Nested lists, images, and custom fonts are not supported.

PRINTING

- Download PDF opens the print dialog.
- Portrait orientation, letter-size paper.
- Turn on background graphics for color.
- Low-ink mode for photocopy runs.

FINAL CHECK BEFORE YOU PUBLISH

- ☐ Title entered
 ☐ Correct document type
 ☐ Content proofread
 ☐ QR code tested
☐ Signature reviewed
 ☐ Print preview checked